



HOW I BECAME A #VANDERBILTMOM

“The Talk”



PUBLIC:



- Intentionally created with the intent to:
 - *Share our story*
 - *Uncover and openly discuss concerns*
 - *Provide a platform for sharing information as it is discovered*
 - *Serve as a resource matching tool*
 - *Facilitate questions from the general public quickly and easily*

Who, Me?

Ready or not: Here we come...

In retrospect we had NO CLUE if we were ready to share our lives so publicly or if we were doing the right thing for our family, but knew we had to speak up for the greater good.

SOMEONE had to :

- *step up and start asking the difficult questions.*
- *set the bar high and keep opening doors.*
- *continue the work of challenging the stigma associated with disability.*

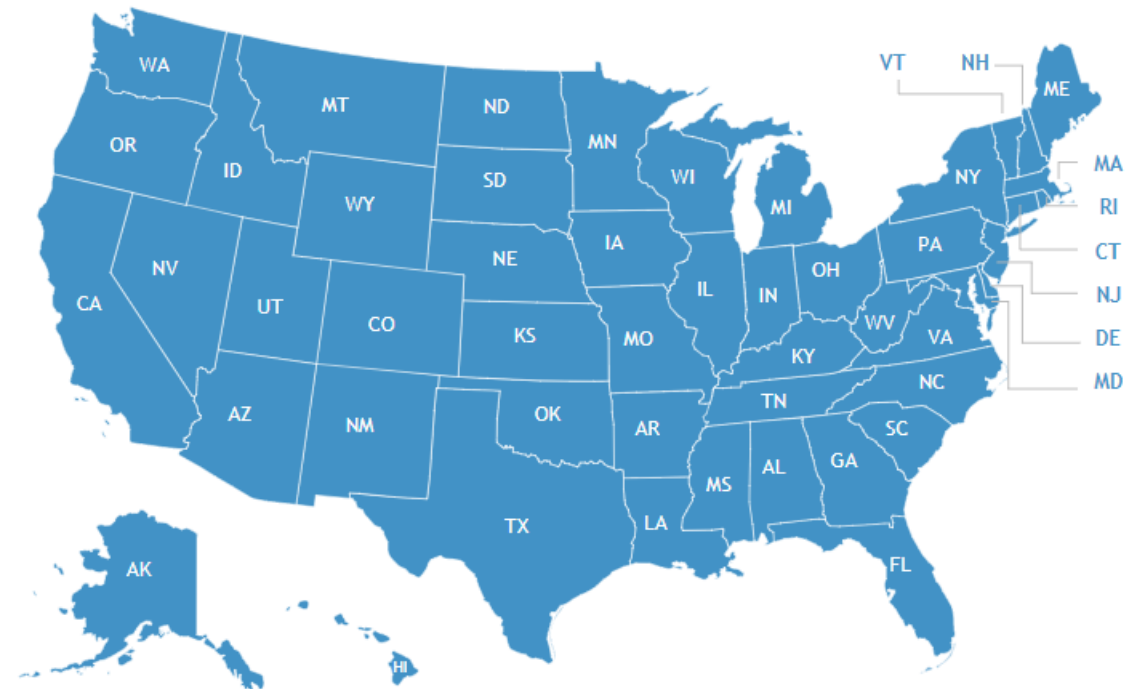
From DREAM... to REALITY aka The COLLEGE ROAD TRIP!



U.S. Department of Education

WHAT'S HAPPENING IN YOUR STATE

Click your state on the map to learn about activities near you related to postsecondary education for students with intellectual disability.



The lineup ...



Contestants	Chloe Approved	SuperMom and GlitterDad Approved
University of South Carolina	Food Plan	Inclusive Curriculum
Clemson	GO TIGERS!	Student and Faculty Openness and Passion for Inclusion
University of Tennessee	SEC Rivalry	Openness to new ideas; focus on student
Vanderbilt University	"I love it here. It's beautiful."	Student as decision maker.



It's Getting REAL: The Application Process

Common Pieces to a College Application:

- Neuropsych Eval
- Past and Current IEP's
- Letters of Recommendation
- Personal Statement

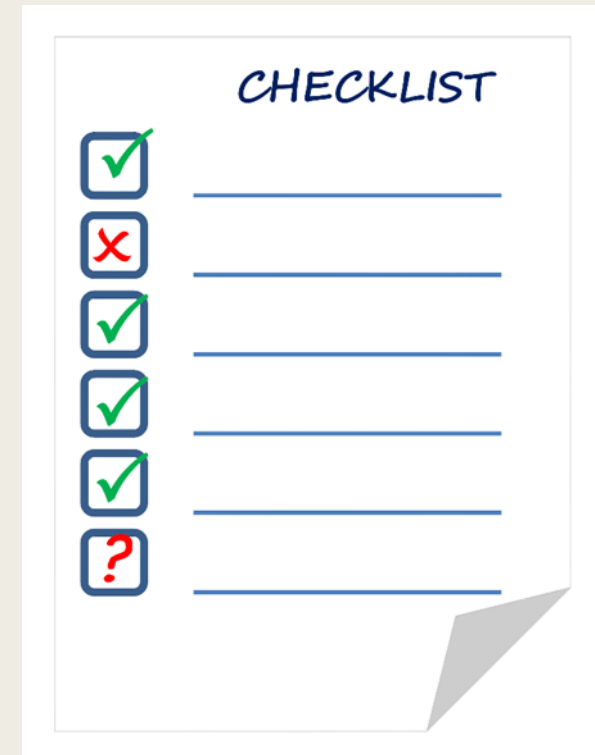
Deadlines and Admission:

- Early & Regular Admission
- Application Deadlines



Tools YOU can use to advocate *(while still in high school):*

- College Entrance Requirements
 - *Use for Goal Setting*
- Career Assessment Results
 - *Use for Course Selection*
- Neuropsychological Evaluation
 - *Use for Placement*



Advocacy: Best Practices & takeaways:

■ Passion vs. Emotion

- *Leave the tissue box at home.*

You'll thank me later, I promise.

■ Goals and Skills

- *A goal is used to acquire a needed skill.*

Period. There's no other reason to create a goal. Appropriate goals translate into a desired skill set!

■ The Right Tech

- *EVERYONE needs technology.*

Technology is everywhere, removes barriers to learning and increases access to the curriculum.

And The Winner Is...

Chloe continues to write her success story and joined the freshman class at Vanderbilt University this fall. She was one of twelve freshman accepted into the Next Steps at Vanderbilt class of 2021.

Congratulations, Chloe!



Q & A

What questions can I answer for you?

Thank YOU!

- Think College

- www.thinkcollege.net

- Next Steps at Vanderbilt

- <https://peabody.vanderbilt.edu/departments/nextsteps/index.php>

- Include Me

- www.includemeadvocacygroup.com